

Current Events





About the Course

Students are exposed to current events by reading from a variety of sources and having conversations with teachers. Topics such as scientific discoveries, the arts, and human interest stories are generally suitable.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 9 (Canada), Citizenship: Grade 10 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 10 (Canada), Citizenship: Grade 11 (U.S.), Citizenship: Grade 11 (Canada), Citizenship: Grade 12



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Current Events: Grades 9-12 1+ time/week 20 min	

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 3 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12				Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) Current Events: Grades 9-12
Citizenship: Grade 9 (Canada)				
Ethics: Part 3 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12				Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (Canada) Current Events: Grades 9-12
Citizenship: Grade 10 (U.S.)				
Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.)	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12 Current Events: Grades 9-12		Ethics: Part 4	
Citizenship: Grade 10 (Canada)				
Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (Canada)	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12 Current Events: Grades 9-12		Ethics: Part 4	
Citizenship: Grade 11 (U.S.)				
Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (U.S.) Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Current Events: Grades 9-12		Ethics: Part 5 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	
Citizenship: Grade 11 (Canada)				
Econ/Civics: Grade 11 (Canada) Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12	Current Events: Grades 9-12		Ethics: Part 5	
Citizenship: Grade 12				
Civics/Ethics: Grade 12	Current Events: Grades 9-12	Economics: Grade 12		Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Current Events: Grades 9-12

☐ Set up a Citizenship Notebook. You can do it multiple ways, but having a 3-ring binder, lined notebook paper, and about 5 tabbed dividers often works well. You can read more about how to set one up and suggestions for various sections in the Quick Links.

☐ Make a Calendar of Events for Current Events lessons by drawing a calendar grid in a notebook (or print a blank calendar from the internet).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Current Events: Grades 9-12

- ∞ [The Pour Over | Subscribe](#)
- ∞ [The World and Everything In It](#)
- ∞ [The Sift](#)
- ∞ [BBC](#)
- ∞ [Teaching Kids News \(CA\)](#)
- ∞ [1Jour1Actu \(in French\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



Current Events: Grades 9-12

How To Approach



Prepare

If you, the student, are learning at home, work to schedule a time with your teacher when you can complete the lessons from *Ourselves* or your Ethics reading together, as these lessons are much richer when shared and discussed.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources: Scan the headlines first to get an overview, and then choose a story to read.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen for the time assigned. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your commonplace book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. To keep yourself on track, you might want to set a timer so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

After your narration, think about how what you read connects to other subjects, other books, other things you've read or watched, or seen in the past or present. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions together to discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Record important ideas in your Citizenship Notebooks. Make a calendar of current events.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. You may also want to preview and choose which news sites to offer students.

Those educating at home might pick one lesson to read aloud (such as the Ethics readings on Cultural Engagement, Conscience, etc.) with their students to keep up the habit of oral narration and foster conversation and relationship and then simply give students these lesson plans and the rest of the books and check in with them throughout the term for conversation, support, and accountability.



It is valuable for those in a classroom setting to also have a mix of lessons, which students complete themselves silently, and others read aloud and narrated together. Classroom settings lend themselves well to additional discussion and sharing at the end of lessons, after everyone has narrated either together or independently in writing.

Current Events: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 2 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 2

→ NOTE

Remember to read news stories regularly and to choose a variety of stories from a variety of places.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 3 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 4 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 4

→ NOTE

Remember to read news stories regularly and to choose a variety of stories from a variety of places.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 5 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 5

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 6 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 6

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 7 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 7

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 8 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 8

→ NOTE

Remember to read news stories regularly and to choose a variety of stories from a variety of places.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

Current Events: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 9 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 9 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Choose an article on Science this week and discuss it with a parent/teacher. Enter the story on your Calendar of Events. Locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.	
WEEK 10 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 10 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas..	
WEEK 11 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 11 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.	
WEEK 12 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 12 <i>Exams</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Current Events: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 13

→ NOTE

Remember to read stories regularly and choose from a variety of topics.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 2 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 14

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 3 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 15

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 4 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 16

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 5 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 17

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 6 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 18

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article on international news and discuss it with your teacher or parent.

Enter the story on your Calendar of Events. Locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 7 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 19

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 8 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 20

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article on Science this week and discuss with a parent/teacher.

Enter the story on your Calendar of Events. Locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 9 ☐ 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 21

→ NOTE

Remember to read news stories regularly and to choose a variety of stories from a variety of places.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Current Events: Grades 9-12

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Term 2

	Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.	
WEEK 10	20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 22 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.	
WEEK 11	20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 23 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.	
WEEK 12	20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 24 Exams → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Current Events: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 25

→ NOTE

Choose from a variety of news stories (sports, arts, politics, world, local, and stories in your modern language).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 2 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 26

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 3 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 27

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article on local news and discuss it with your teacher or parent.

Enter the story on your Calendar of Events. Locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 4 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 28

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 5 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 29

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 6 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 30

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article on international news and discuss it with your teacher or parent.

Enter the story on your Calendar of Events. Locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 7 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 31

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 8 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 32

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

WEEK 9 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 33

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Choose an article on Science this week and discuss with a parent/teacher.

Enter the story on your Calendar of Events. Locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.

Current Events: Grades 9-12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 10 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 34 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.	
WEEK 11 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 35 → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Choose an article to read from one of the recommended sites. Write a few bullet points about the event. Enter daily stories on your Calendar and locate unfamiliar places in your atlas.	
WEEK 12 20m Current Events: Grades 9-12 - Lesson 36 <i>Exams</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	

Current Events: Grades 9-12

Examination

Term 1 · Write a journal entry reflecting on any world event from your news reading this term.

Term 2 · Write a journal entry reflecting on any world event from your news reading this term.

Term 3 · Write a journal entry reflecting on any world event from your news reading this term.